GMC

GRANTS MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE

ANNUAL REPORT

JAN 2025 - DEC 2025



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CREATED IN 2022

WHAT IS THE GMC?

The **Grants Management Committee (GMC)** was created to fairly distribute community funds within the **Rocket Pool protocol**. It helps reward past contributions and support future projects through **grants, bounties, and retrospective awards**. Since the Rocket Pool community has always played a big role in growing the ecosystem, the GMC ensures these efforts are recognized and encouraged in a clear and organized way.

The GMC follows set rules to review applications and prevent conflicts of interest. It is mostly made up of community members, not Rocket Pool's core team, to keep decisions fair. The process is transparent, and anyone can challenge decisions if needed. By **funding valuable projects and contributions**, the GMC helps Rocket Pool grow and improve for everyone.



NINE ELECTED MEMBERS

MEET THE COMMITTEE

YEAR 3



DR DOOFUS



WAQ



STEELY



LENOFTAWA



SCKUZZLE



KEN



KEVSTER



DESTROYAAA



RAMANA

YEAR 4



DR DOOFUS



WAQ



STEELY



EPINEPH



SCKUZZLE



KEN



DESTROYAAA

GRANTS

PURPOSE OF GRANTS

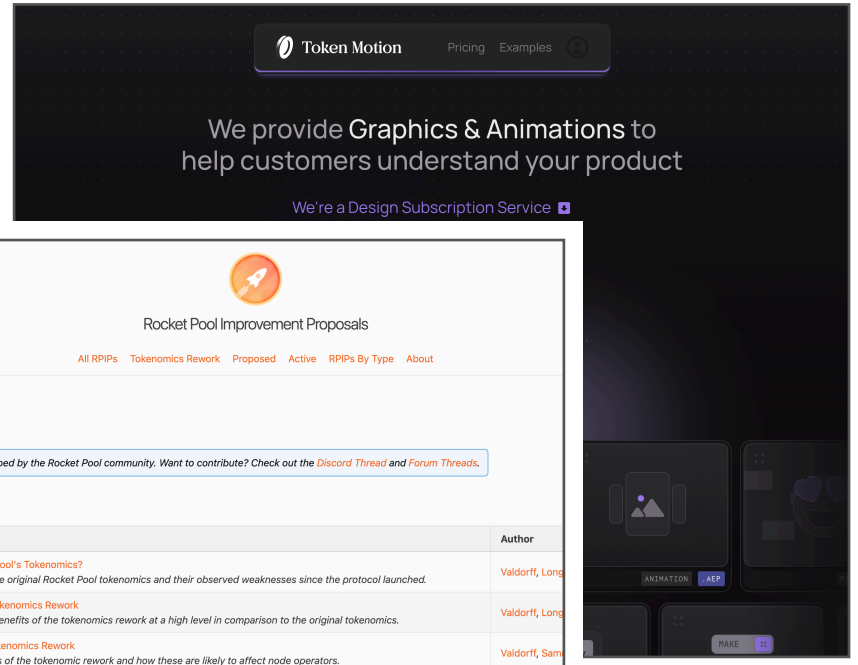
Grants are designed for individuals or teams who plan to complete a specific project that benefits the Rocket Pool ecosystem. These grants provide funding for initiatives that align with the protocol's goals, such as building tools, creating educational content, or improving community resources. If someone has a project idea and intends to execute it themselves, they would apply for a grant.

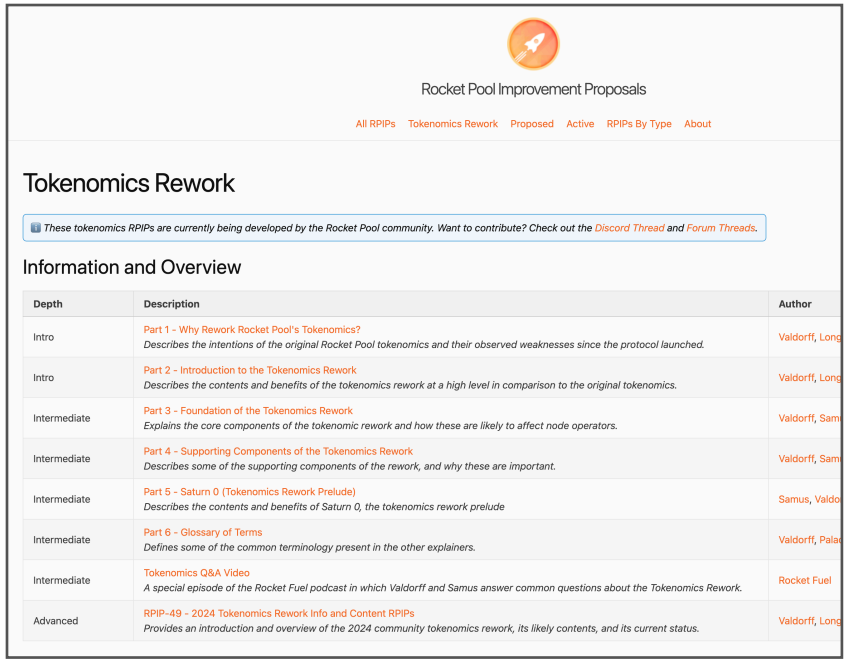
GMC GOALS

Grants should contribute to one or more of the following objectives:
Encouraging new node operators to join, supporting existing node operators in managing their infrastructure, increasing the adoption and utility of rETH, and enhancing the overall ecosystem and community experience.

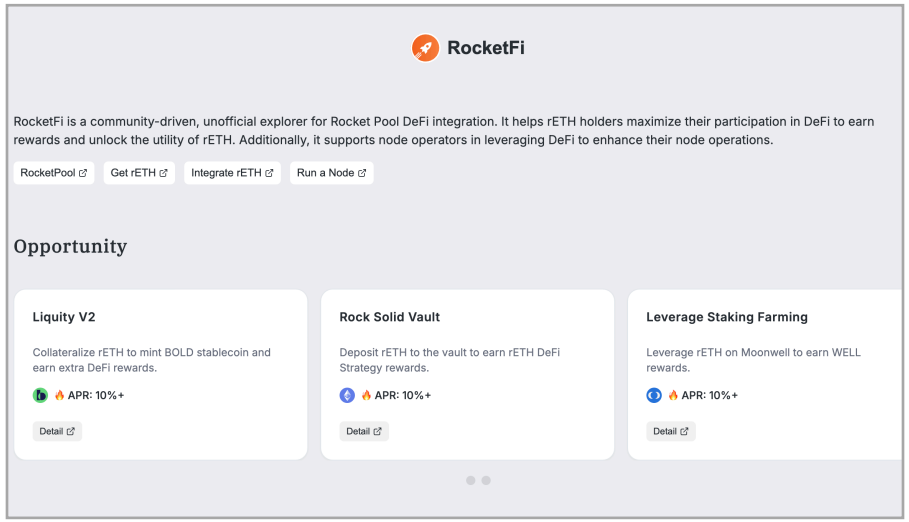
GRANTS EVALUATION CRITERIA

When reviewing grant applications, the GMC considers how well the project aligns with Rocket Pool's mission, the feasibility of the proposal given the applicant's experience and resources, and the expected impact relative to the funding requested.





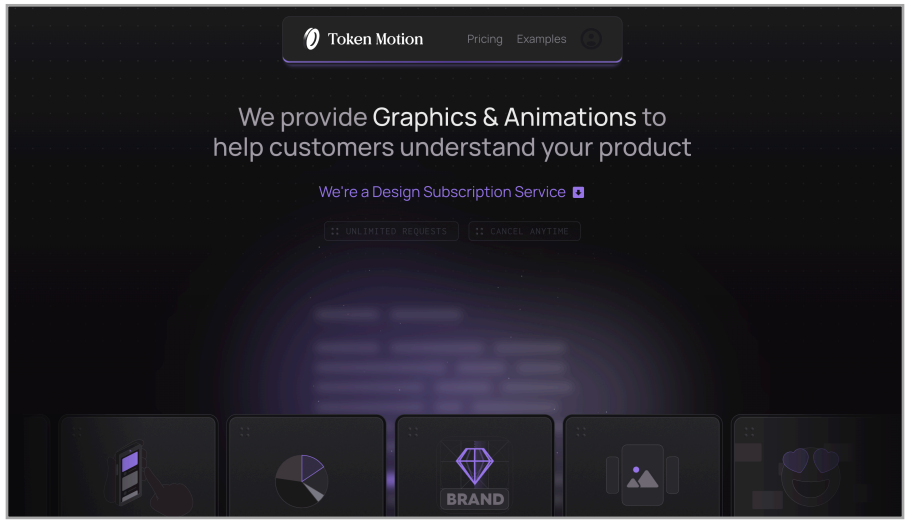
NOTABLE GRANTS



SIGNALXU

ROCKETFI

RocketFi is a community-driven, unofficial explorer for Rocket Pool DeFi integration. It helps rETH holders maximize their participation in DeFi to earn rewards and unlock the utility of rETH. Additionally, it supports node operators in leveraging DeFi to enhance their node operations.



TOKEN MOTION

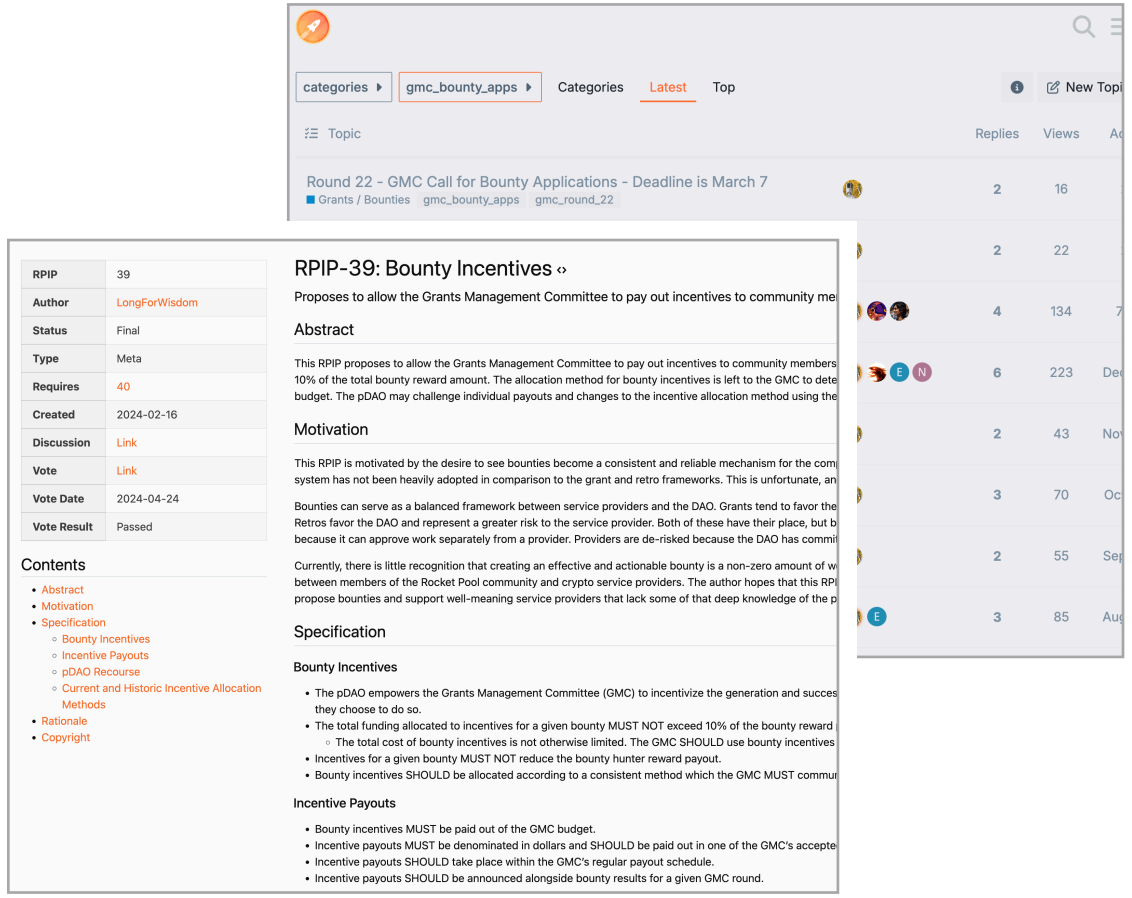
DESIGN SUBSCRIPTION

Dedicated professional graphic design, branding and animation service for the Rocket Pool team, the GMC and the Rocket Pool community. Two six-month grants were funded in 2025.

BOUNTIES

PURPOSE OF BOUNTIES

Bounties incentivize specific tasks or projects that benefit the Rocket Pool ecosystem, allowing anyone to complete them and claim the reward. Unlike grants, which fund individuals or teams to carry out their own proposals, bounties provide predefined objectives that the broader community can work toward. It's building anything that contributes to Rocket Pool's growth without requiring a specific individual to take ownership in advance.



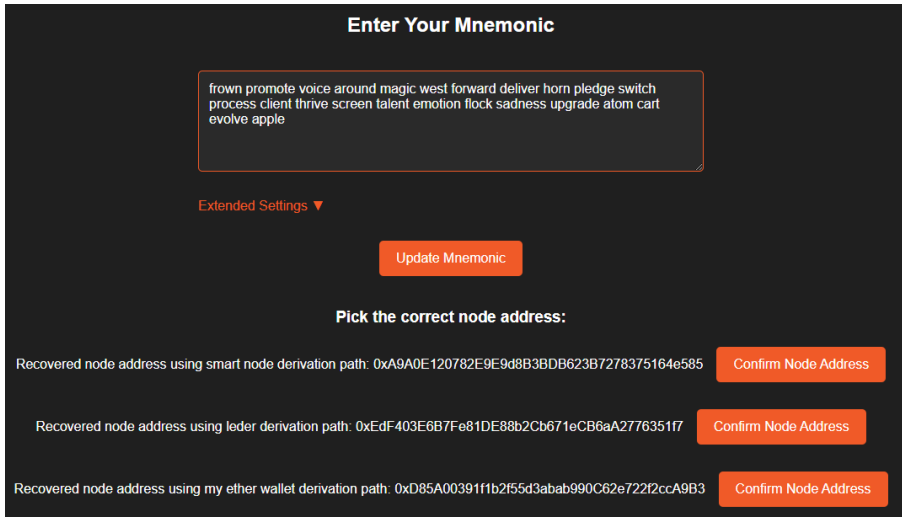
GMC GOALS

Bounties should contribute to one or more of the following objectives:
Encouraging participation from a wider range of contributors, supporting the protocol's decentralization by enabling open competition for solutions, increasing the adoption and utility of rETH, and improving the overall experience for node operators and community members.

BOUNTIES EVALUATION CRITERIA

When assessing bounty proposals, the GMC considers how well the task aligns with Rocket Pool's mission, whether it is clearly defined and achievable by community members, and whether the proposed reward is appropriate relative to the task's impact on the protocol.

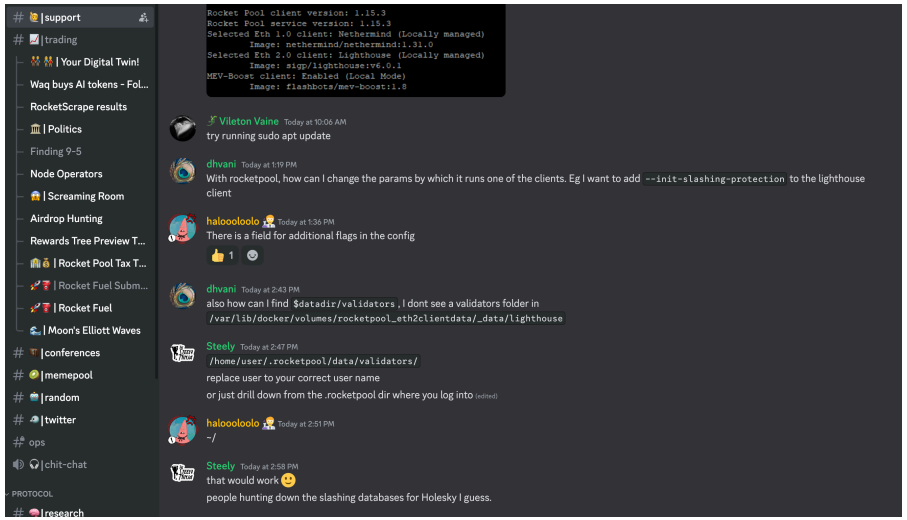
NOTABLE BOUNTIES



PATCHES

JUST EXIT MY VALIDATORS

This tool allows you to recover your node address using your mnemonic, derive all associated validator private keys, and generate a signed exit message - especially if you no longer have direct access to your smartnode.



HALOOOOLOOLO

ROCKET POOL SUPPORT

Provided support for questions posed by Rocket Pool community members in the # support discord channel; questions come largely from Node Operators and those hoping to be Node Operators.

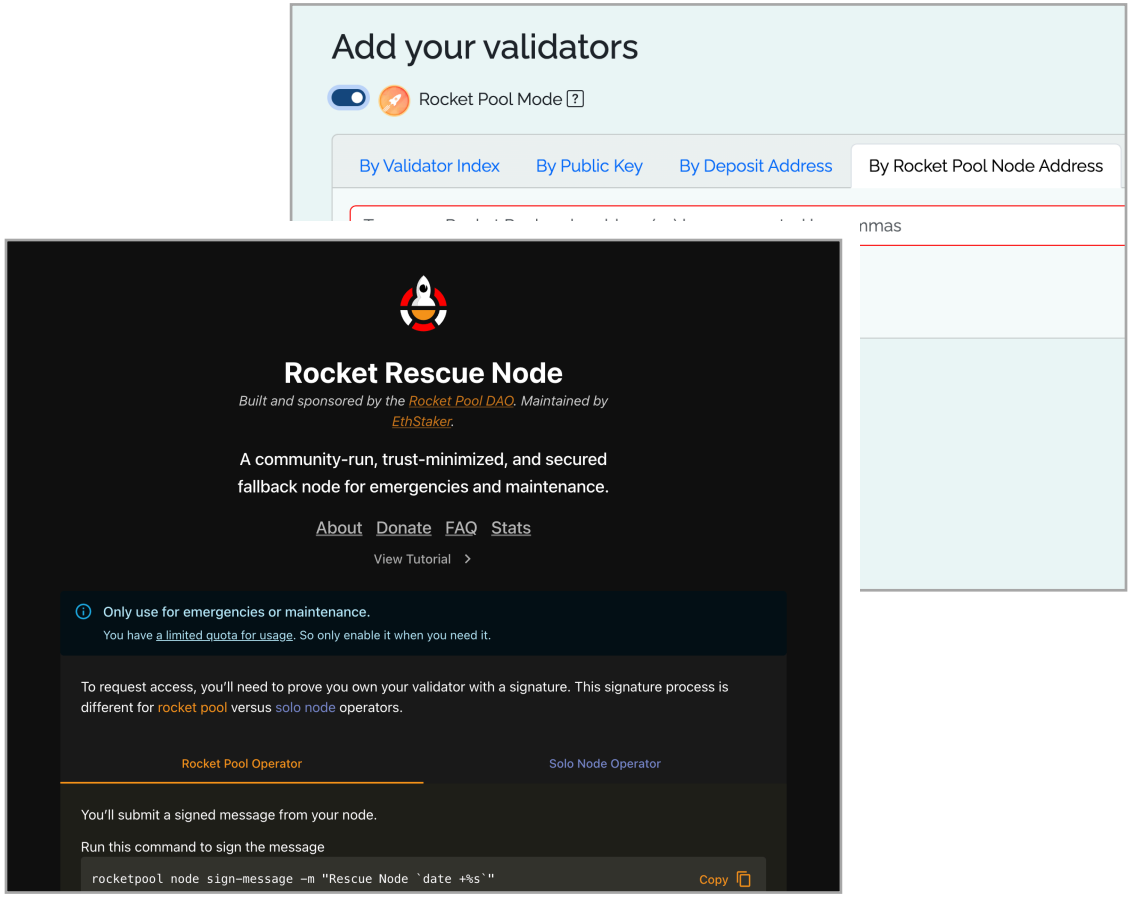
RETROSPECTIVE AWARDS

PURPOSE OF RETROSPECTIVE AWARDS

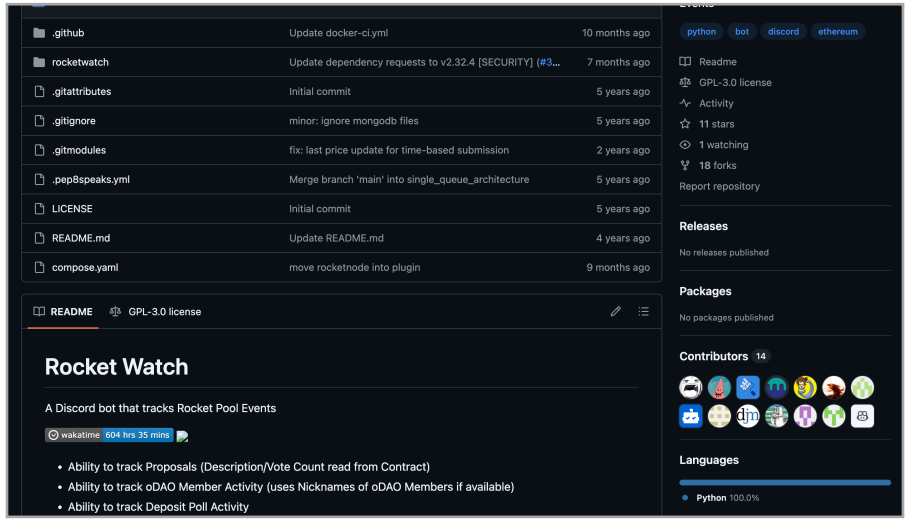
Retrospective awards recognize and reward work that has already been completed and has contributed to the Rocket Pool ecosystem. Unlike grants and bounties, which fund future efforts, retrospective awards provide compensation for past initiatives that have demonstrably advanced the protocol's goals. These awards can be self-submitted or nominated by someone else who believes the work deserves recognition.

RETROS EVALUATION CRITERIA

When reviewing retrospective award submissions, the GMC considers how significantly the completed work has furthered Rocket Pool's mission and objectives. If the project is ongoing, the award applies only to work completed before the current award period. Any future funding for the same project must be submitted as a separate grant application and evaluated accordingly.



NOTABLE RETROSPECTIVE AWARDS



HALOOOLOOLO

ROCKET WATCH CONTRIBUTIONS

Rocket Watch contributions represent a year of open-source work that expanded event tracking, governance support, scam prevention, and tooling for node operators and rETH holders. The work also included major internal refactors that improved the bot's reliability and ability to keep up with protocol changes.



FOMO FACTOR

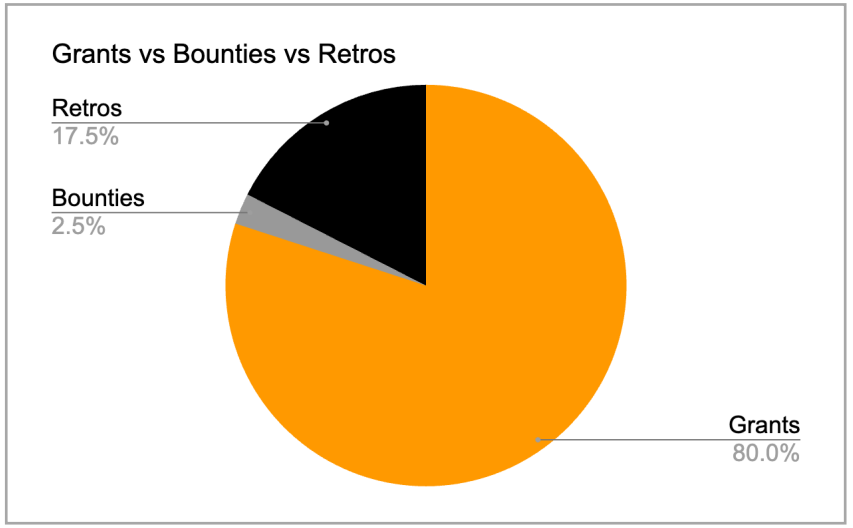
ETH DENVER SIDE EVENT

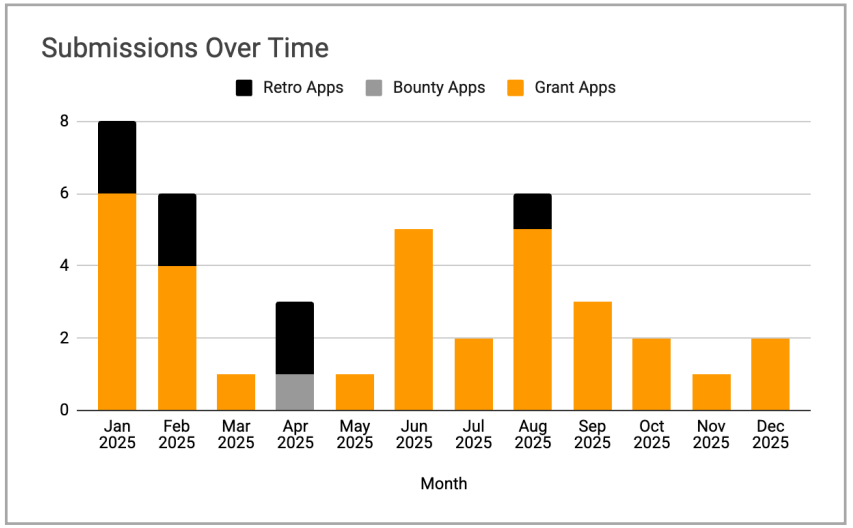
Developed an interactive bounty board site, currently hosted at rpbountyboard.com. Contributed various items of process work, recommendations, and advice provided with the aim of improving the bounty process.

2025 APPLICATION HISTORY

Month	Total Apps	Grant Apps	Bounty Apps	Retro Apps	Approved	% Approved
Jan 2025	8	6	0	2	4	50.00%
Feb 2025	6	4	0	2	3	50.00%
Mar 2025	1	1	0	0	0	0.00%
Apr 2025	3	0	1	2	3	100.00%
May 2025	1	1	0	0	1	100.00%
Jun 2025	5	5	0	0	5	100.00%
Jul 2025	2	2	0	0	1	50.00%
Aug 2025	6	5	0	1	3	50.00%
Sep 2025	3	3	0	0	1	33.33%
Oct 2025	2	2	0	0	2	100.00%
Nov 2025	1	1	0	0	1	100.00%
Dec 2025	2	2	0	0	1	50.00%
Average	**3**	**3**	**0**	**1**	**2**	**65.28%**

Source: [GMC Historical Data 2025 - Sheet]

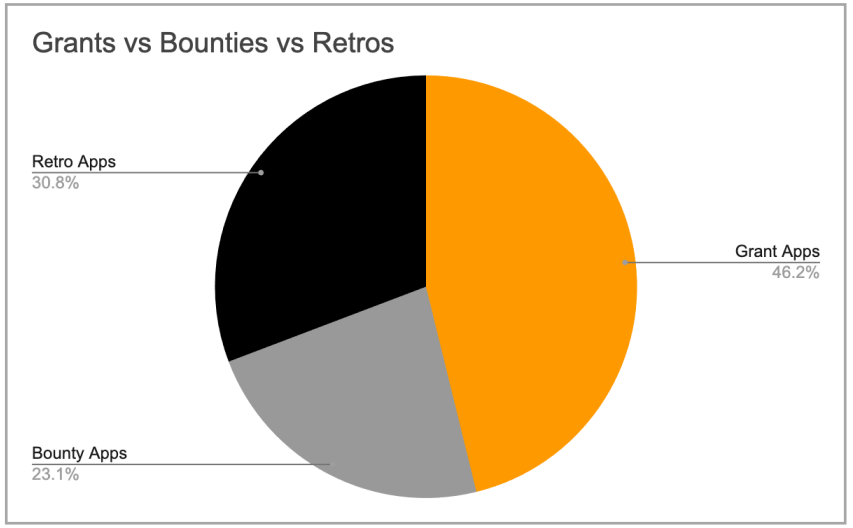


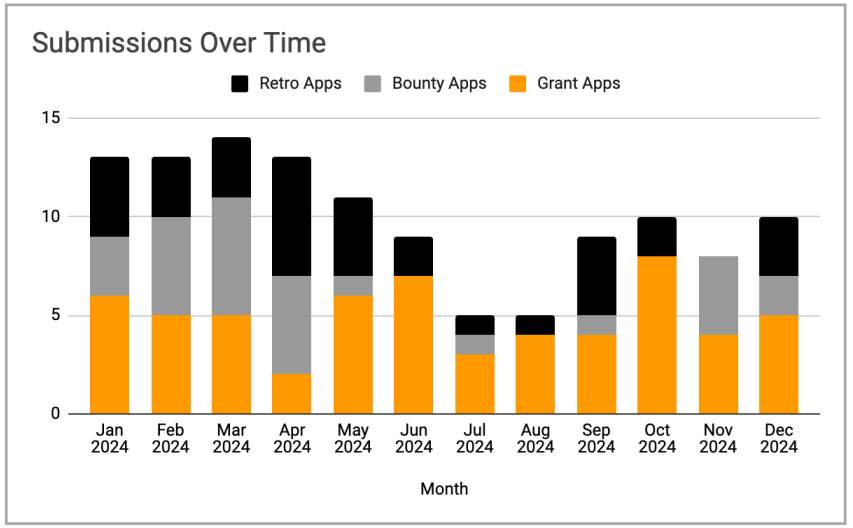


2024 APPLICATION HISTORY

Month	Total Apps	Grant Apps	Bounty Apps	Retro Apps	Approved	% Approved
Jan 2024	13	6	3	4	8	61.54%
Feb 2024	13	5	5	3	7	53.85%
Mar 2024	14	5	6	3	7	50.00%
Apr 2024	13	2	5	6	11	84.62%
May 2024	11	6	1	4	6	54.55%
Jun 2024	9	7	0	2	7	77.78%
Jul 2024	5	3	1	1	4	80.00%
Aug 2024	5	4	0	1	3	60.00%
Sep 2024	9	4	1	4	7	77.78%
Oct 2024	10	8	0	2	5	50.00%
Nov 2024	8	4	4	0	3	37.50%
Dec 2024	10	5	2	3	9	90.00%
Average	**10**	**5**	**2**	**3**	**6**	**64.80%**

Source: [GMC Historical Data 2024 - Sheet]

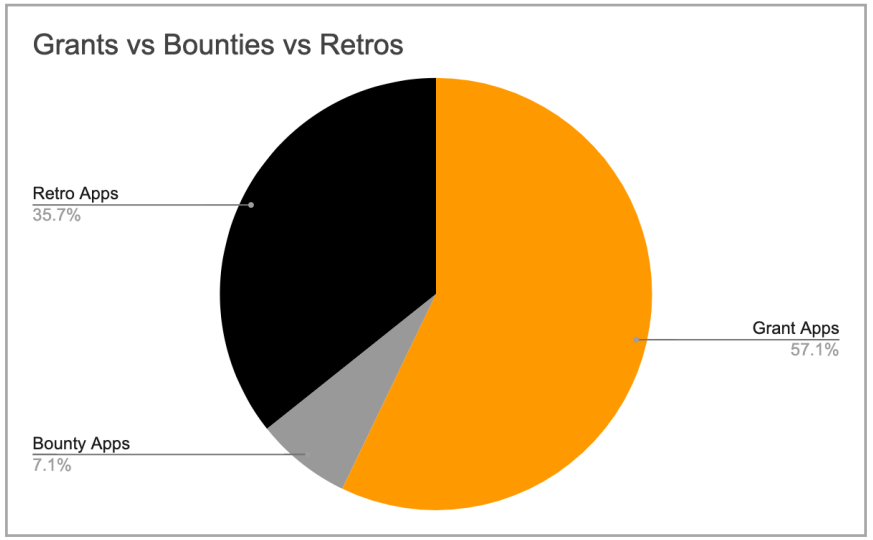


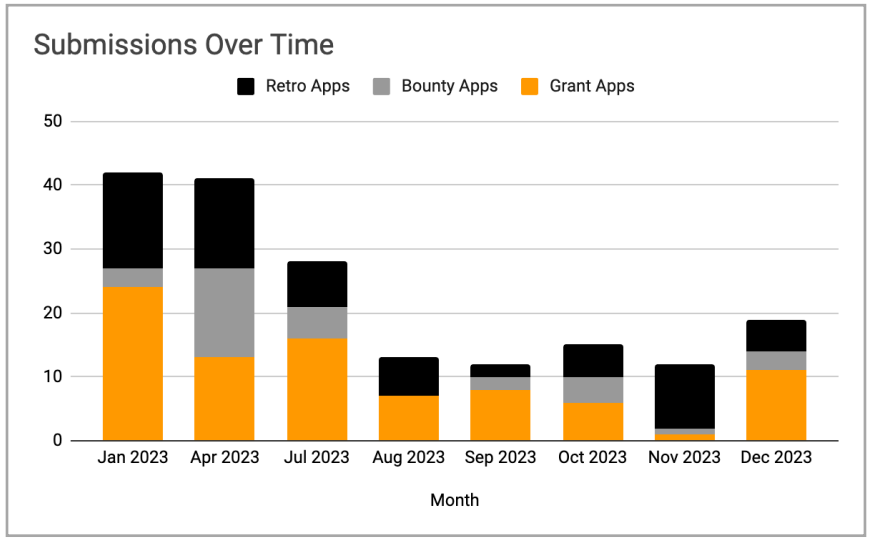


2023 APPLICATION HISTORY

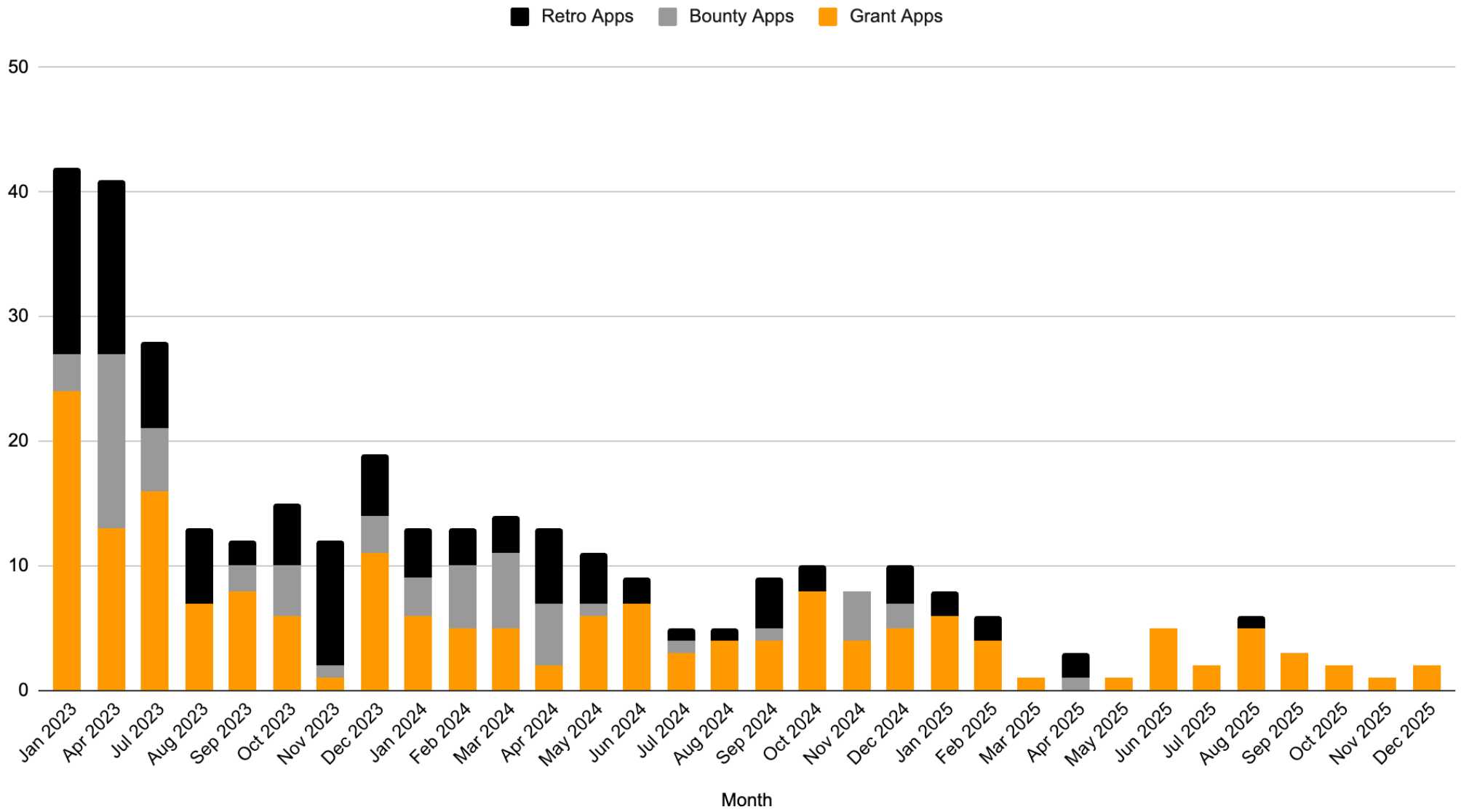
Month	Total Apps	Grant Apps	Bounty Apps	Retro Apps	Approved	% Approved
Jan 2023	42	24	3	15	27	64.29%
Apr 2023	41	13	14	14	25	60.98%
Jul 2023	28	16	5	7	20	71.43%
Aug 2023	13	7	0	6	11	84.62%
Sep 2023	12	8	2	2	3	25.00%
Oct 2023	15	6	4	5	8	53.33%
Nov 2023	12	1	1	10	11	91.67%
Dec 2023	19	11	3	5	13	68.42%
Average	**23**	**11**	**4**	**8**	**15**	**64.97%**

Source: GMC Historical Data 2023 - Sheet





APPLICATION HISTORY OVER TIME

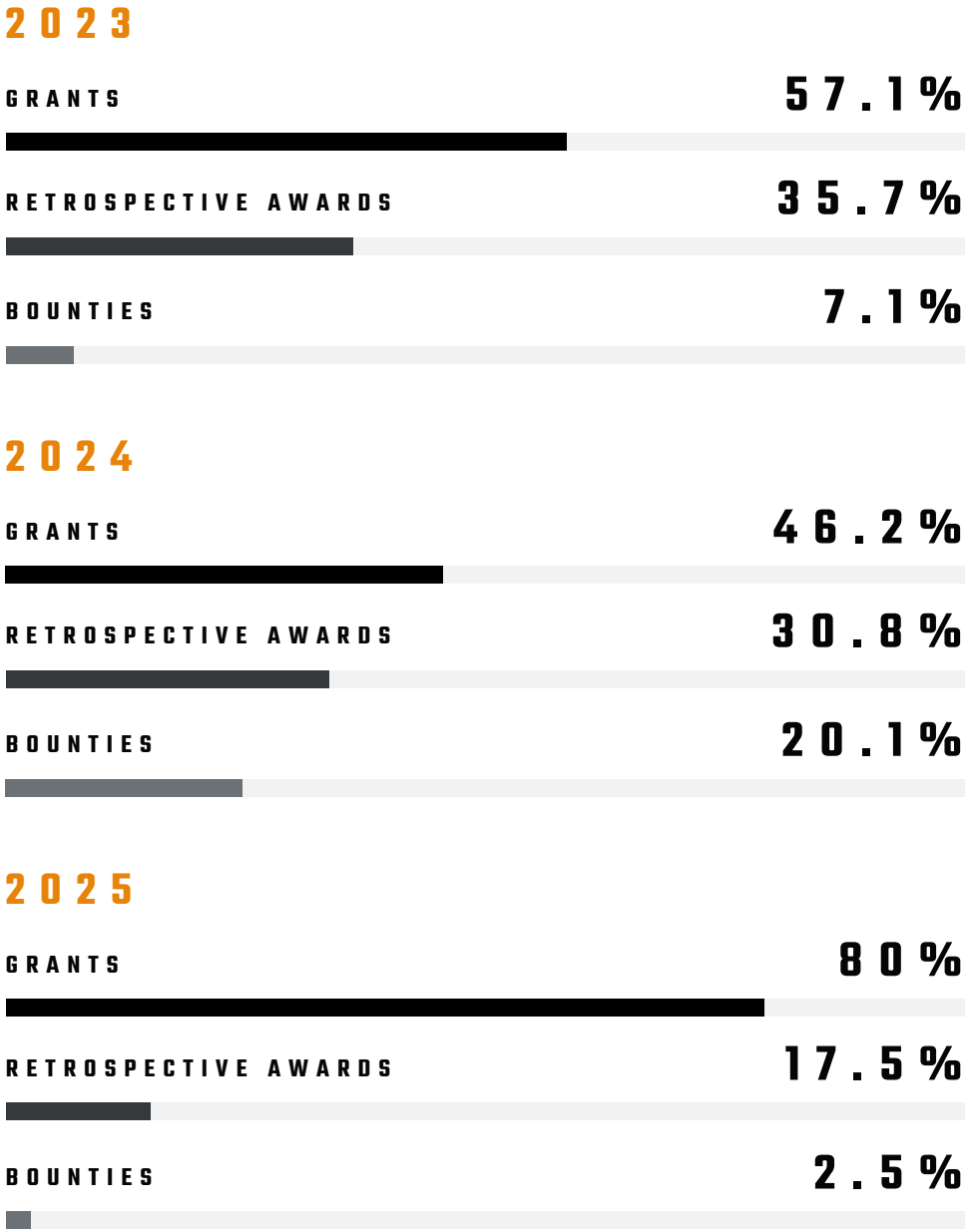


APPLICATION SUMMARY

In the second year (2024), the committee observed a more balanced distribution of application types. Grant and retrospective award applications decreased, while bounty submissions increased. This shift was partly due to the **first year's surge in retrospective applications**, which reflected work completed before the committee's inception.

In the third year (2025), overall application submissions continued to trend downward. With the **treasury's value significantly reduced**, the GMC stated it would prioritize **funding only "emergency" applications** until conditions improve.

The bounty system, which received significant financial and time investment in late 2023 and early 2024, never fully gained traction. Most bounties were submitted by highly technical applicants, and when those individuals were unavailable to review the work, the projects became difficult to manage and bring to completion.



Development		
Community Resource	$	14,880.00
Development Feature	$	44,243.00
Development Maintenance	$	14,649.66

Governance		
DAO Governance	$	-
Administration	$	155,670.83
Refunds	$	-

Research		
Research	$	15,000.00

Support		
Support	$	56,000.01

Marketing		
Videos	$	60,766.69
Business Development	$	41,828.00
Marketing Materials	$	-
Streams	$	8,200.00
Education	$	-
POAPs	$	100.00
Conferences	$	3,000.00
Graphic Design	$	29,570.40

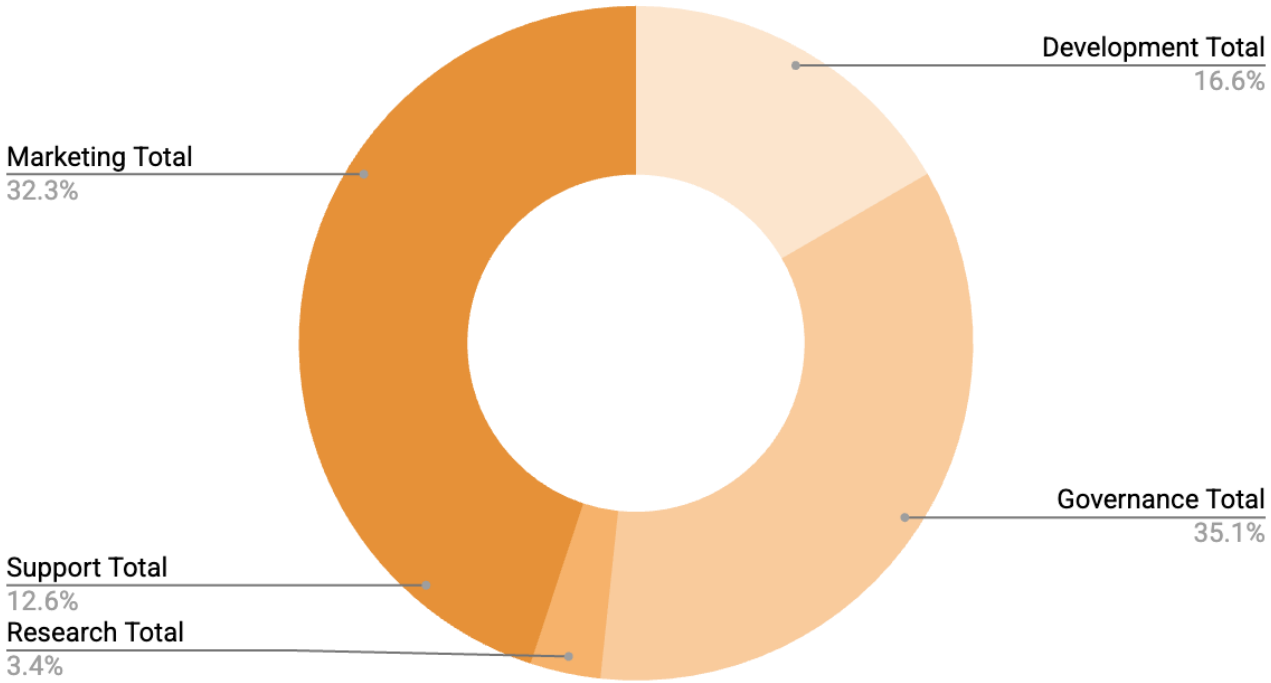
Public Goods		
Public Goods	$	-

Totals		
Development Total	**$**	**73,772.66**
Governance Total	**$**	**155,670.83**
Research Total	**$**	**15,000.00**
Support Total	**$**	**56,000.01**
Marketing Total	**$**	**143,465.09**
Public Goods Total	**$**	**-**

Total Spend **$ 443,908.59**

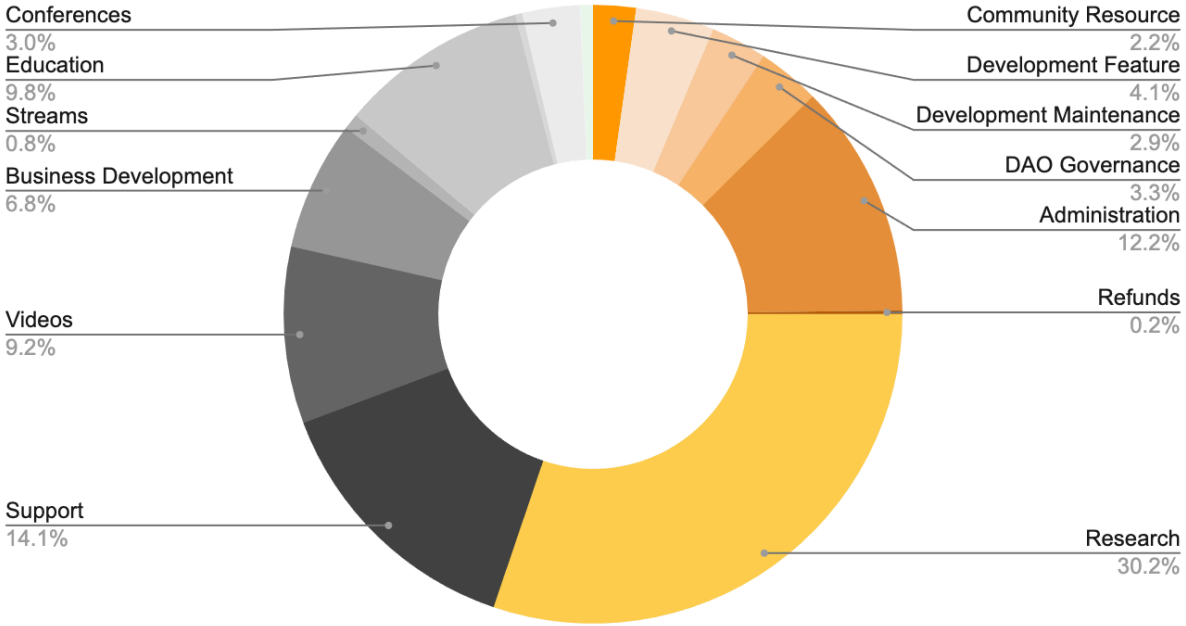
CATEGORIES OF PROJECTS FUNDED

FUNDING ALLOCATION



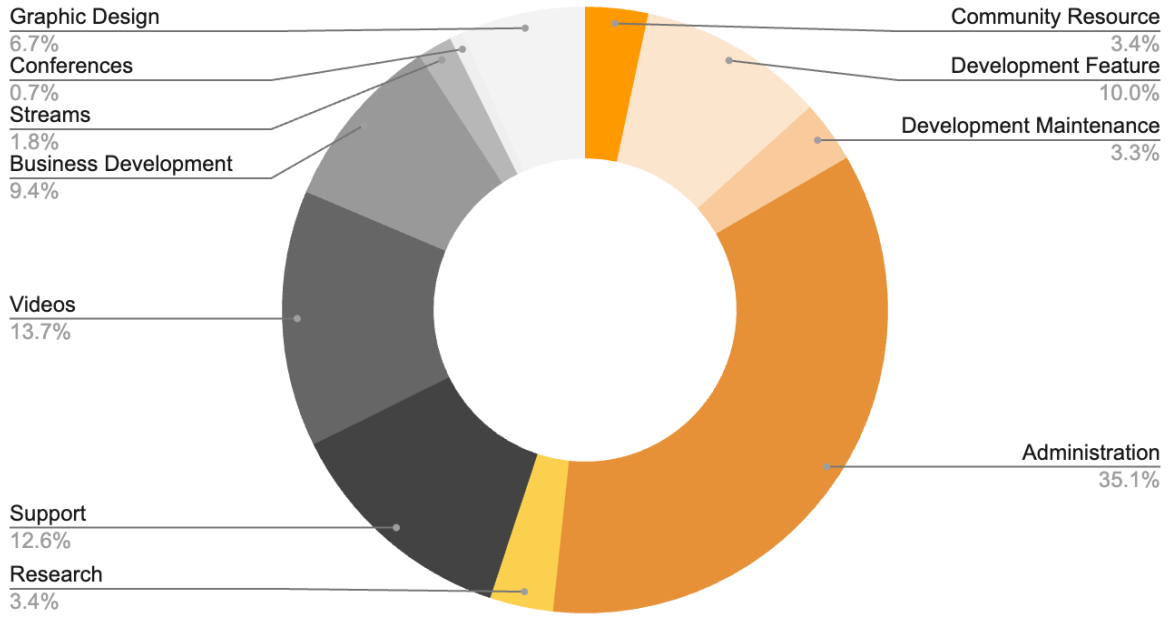
Source: Treasury Accounting Sheet

FUNDING ALLOCATION DETAILED



Total Spend: $1.03M

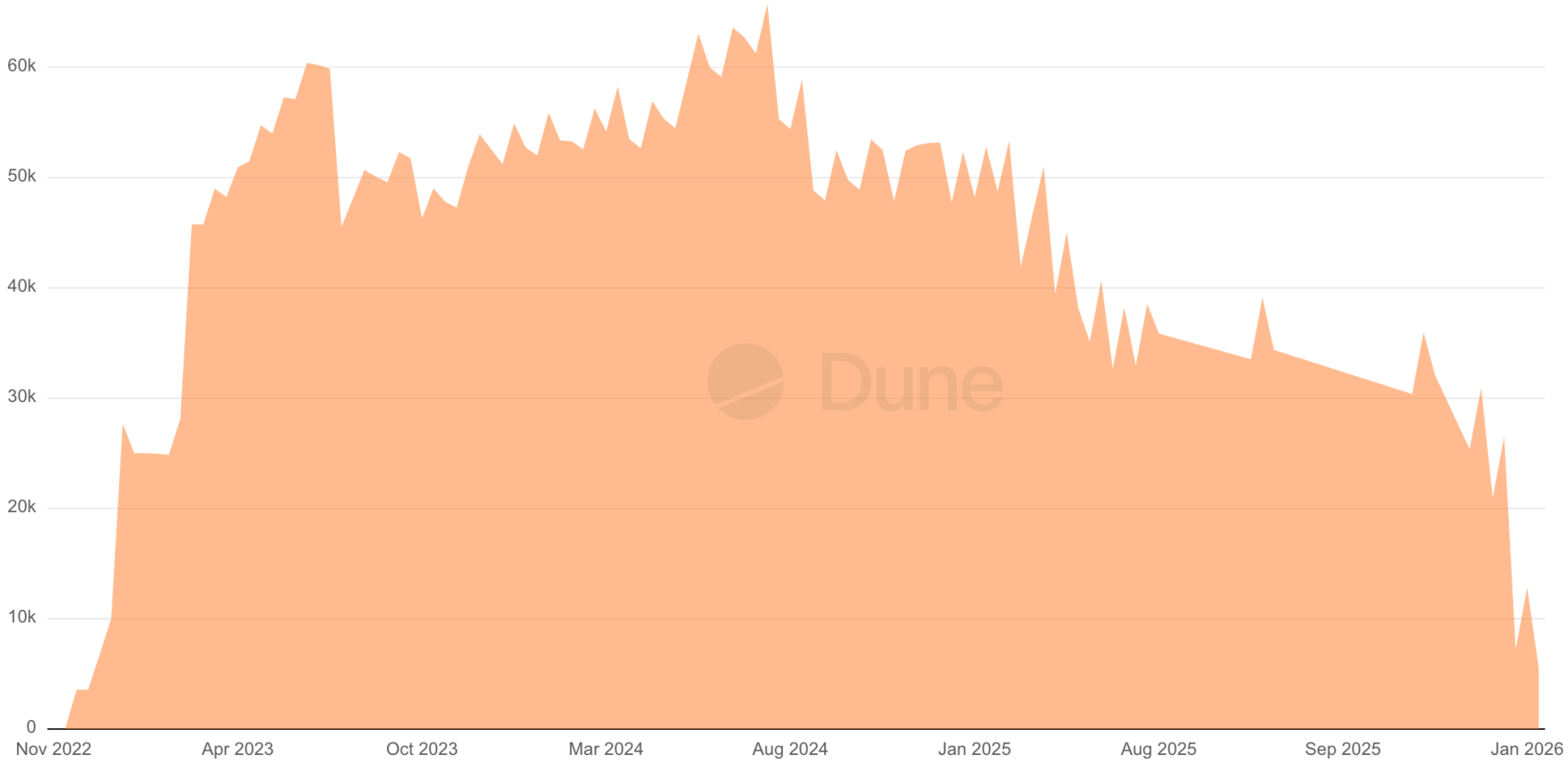
2024



Total Spend: $443k

2025

TREASURY HISTORY (RPL)(ALL-TIME)

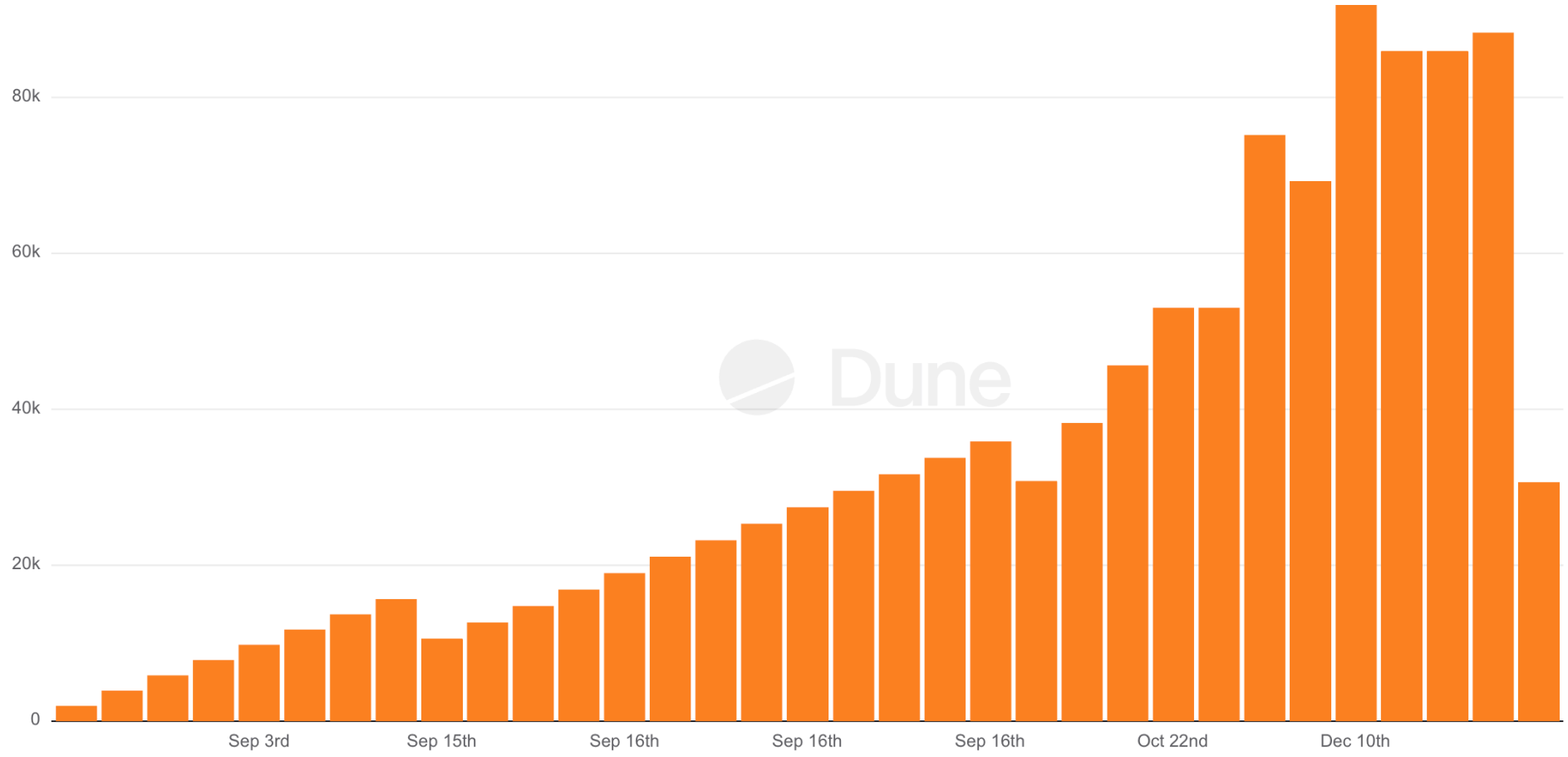


Net RPL: 5,520

01/29/25

Source: https://dune.com/shfryn/gmc-treasury

TREASURY HISTORY (BOLD)(ALL-TIME)



Net BOLD:

30,610

01/29/25

Source: https://dune.com/shfryn/gmc-treasury

2025 GMC TREASURY BALANCE DATA

48,221

JAN 2024
RPL BALANCE

12,830

JAN 2025
RPL BALANCE

-73.4%

RPL BALANCE CHANGE

5,244.05

MONTHLY
RPL INFLOW

9,111.85

MONTHLY
RPL OUTFLOW

In the year 2025, the GMC spent less than any other prior year, but exhausted far more RPL due to the decreasing token price.

The GMC did pass a proposal to increase its monthly RPL share of inflation from around 4,500 RPL to around 5,500 RPL.

TREASURY SUMMARY

By mid-2025, the GMC adopted a more conservative funding posture in response to the continued decline in RPL price and its impact on the treasury. Several recurring grants were reduced or discontinued as a result. While the pDAO share of RPL inflation under the updated tokenomics may provide additional capital to the committee, RPL market price remains the primary determinant of the GMC's runway and overall financial stability.

2024 USD VALUE

$1,593,377.40

RPL PRICE - $31.10

RPL BALANCE - 51,234

2025 USD VALUE

$601,852.50

RPL PRICE - $11.50

RPL BALANCE - 52,335

2026 USD VALUE*

$25,660

RPL PRICE - $2.00

RPL BALANCE - 12,830 BOLD BALANCE - 85,908

Values are taken on the first day of the year using CoinGecko's RPL value and the amount of RPL tokens held at the time. Value is RPL only.

* In 2026, the GMC added BOLD. The USD value of the entire treasury was **$111,568.**

2024

51,234
JAN 2024
RPL BALANCE

52,335
DEC 2024
RPL BALANCE

+2.15%
RPL BALANCE
CHANGE

5,051.46
APPROX MONTHLY
RPL INFLOW

4,959.72
APPROX MONTHLY
RPL OUTFLOW

2025

48,221
JAN 2025
RPL BALANCE

12,830
DEC 2025
RPL BALANCE

-73.4%
RPL BALANCE
CHANGE

5,244.05
APPROX MONTHLY
RPL INFLOW

9,111.85
APPROX MONTHLY
RPL OUTFLOW



2025

GRANTS APPROVED

RPL DEFI
ROCKET FUEL #4
RESCUE NODE #4
COMMUNITY CALLS
PATCHES X RPL TEAM #3
TOKEN MOTION SUBSCRIPTION

CYFRIN EXAM VOUCHERS
STAR OVERSEER
TOKEN MOTION SUBSCRIPTION #2
RESCUE NODE #5
COMMUNITY CALLS #2
ROCKET FUEL #5



2025

BOUNTIES APPROVED

SUPPORT PAYMENTS #4

SUPPORT PAYMENTS #5

JUST EXIT MY VALIDATORS

FEE SWITCH PREVIEW CALCULATOR



2025

RETROS APPROVED

SUBSCRIPTION RETRO
ADDITIONAL COMMUNITY CALLS
LLC COMPENSATION
NODE & MINIPOOL ANALYTICS
ROCKET WATCH CONTRIBUTIONS
THE WEEKLY ORBIT RETRO

RP ORGANIZATION & OUTREACH
RPIP-64 INITIALIZATION & POAP
ADDITIONAL COMMUNITY CALLS
MC GAS REIMBURSEMENT
CLEAR QUEUE GAS REIMBURSEMENT



2025

APPLICATIONS DENIED

AI ASSISTANT
VALIDATOR INTEGRATION
RETH SUPPORT FOR MEV-COMMIT
INVESTMENT PROPOSAL
THE WEEKLY ORBIT
DEFI SEASON SPONSORSHIP
STAKING FORUM SPONSORSHIP
VAULT REWARDS
DIAMOND HANDS MARKETING
BETWEEN THE LINES MEDIA
GRANT PROGRESS TRACKING
MICRO-INFLUENCER CAMPAIGNS
TWO-NODE FAILOVER ARCHITECTURE
VIRTUAL COURSE
ROCKET POOL APP REDESIGN



PROGRESS

GOVERNANCE

GMC BUDGET

In order to combat the RPL price decline, the GMC proposed increasing its share of inflation in RPIP-69.. The proposal successfully passed updating the Grants and Management Committees share from 20.5% to 25%.

However, the USD value of RPL saw an 82.6% decrease from the beginning of the year, which reduced the positive impact of the additional funding received.

BOLD RESERVES

A significant portion of approved grants require payouts several months after acceptance. Although the GMC began the year with a healthy treasury balance, the decline in treasury value later in the year made it more difficult to meet all outstanding grant obligations. In response, the GMC reintroduced a stable reserve directly tied to accepted awards, replacing the prior approach of maintaining a flat reserve percentage.

MEMBER REDUCTION

Over time, application volume has declined, subcommittees are used less frequently, and projected spending for the coming year is lower. Reducing the GMC to seven members better matches the current workload and budget while preserving enough capacity and diversity for effective governance.

BUDGET PROCESS

Over the years the committee has proposed and voted on different budget processes in order to avoid overspending. However, due to the inflexibility of the processes and the variability of the RPL price, a solution has still not been found.

ADMIN

The committee chose to renew ShfRyn for a third year and decreased the compensation for the role which was recommended by ShfRyn.

CHALLENGES

RPL PRICE

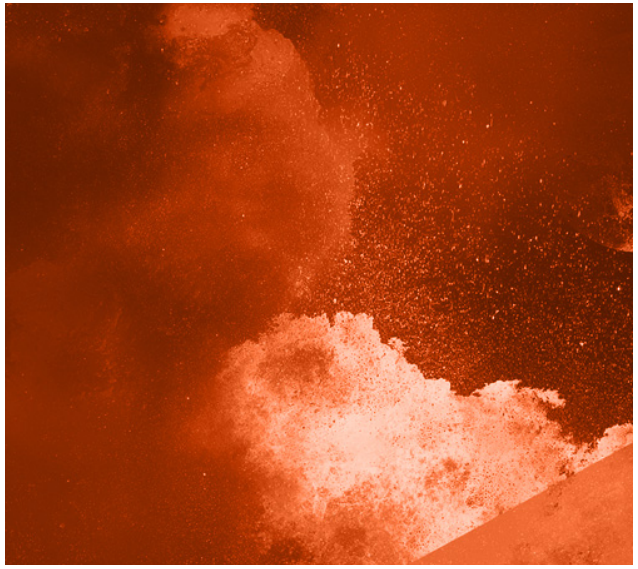
The RPL price decreased drastically compared to prior years. Budgeting became nearly impossible and the committee spent most of the year in emergency mode.

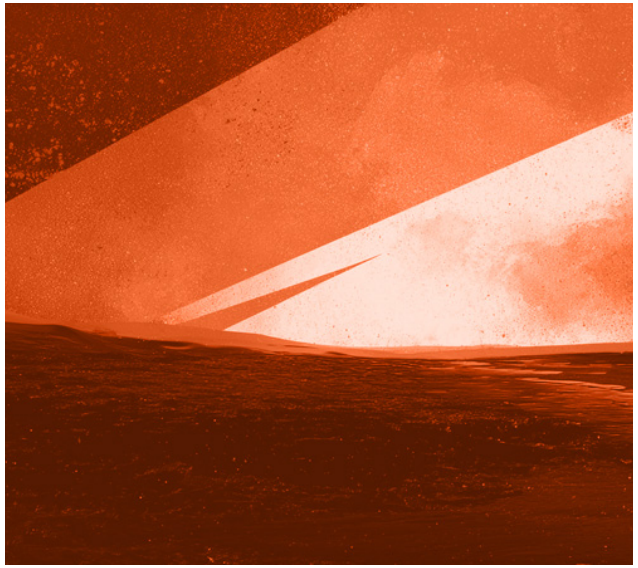
COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

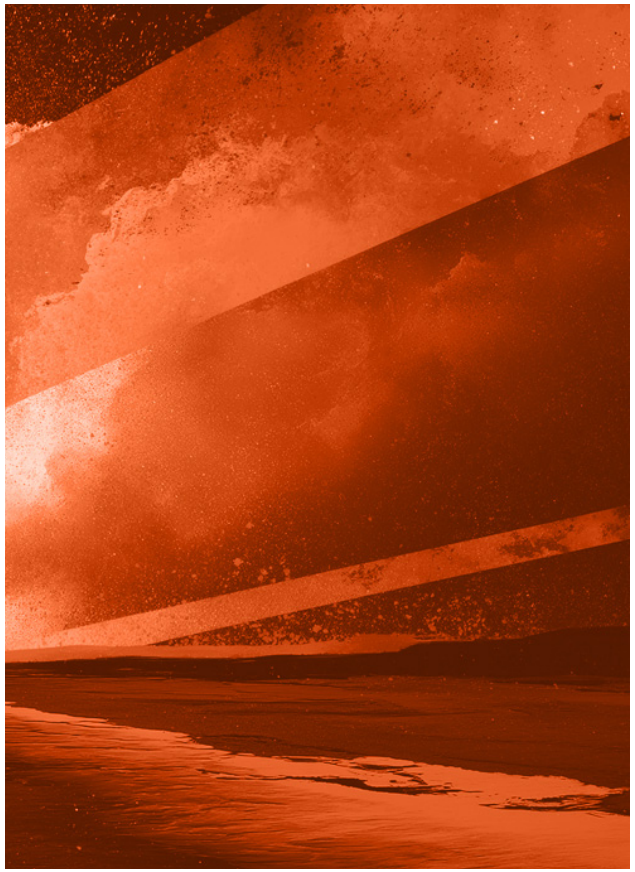
DAO engagement has decreased significantly due to frustrations over the protocol's growth and RPL's token price. The committee relies on community participation to amplify output.

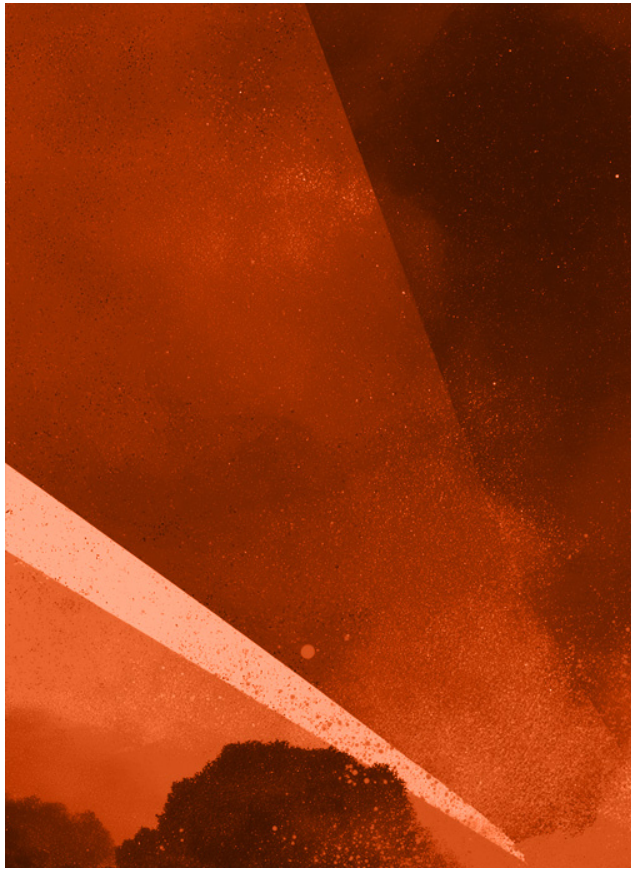
BUSINESS DEV.

Multiple initiatives funded by the committee such as STAR and AlphaGrowth have seen little success. rETH has been an increasingly difficult product to market and sell.













FUNDING ADJUSTMENTS

MARKETING

Given the funding constraints, all media grants saw significant reductions. *The Weekly Orbit* has ended, *Rocket Fuel* chose not to reapply, and the community calls hosted by Ken were scaled back. Additionally, the Cyfrin grant was reduced to remove Saturn 1–related content.

INCENTIVES

Incentive awards increased the amount allocated to reserves. Grants such as STAR and Patches Dev Work were reduced to better align with their updated expected payouts.

MODIFICATIONS

This is the first year the GMC has made so many changes to previously awarded grants. These adjustments were made out of necessity, and the committee remains strongly averse to modifying grants after approval unless absolutely required.

CONCLUSION

THE YEAR AHEAD - 2026

The theme for 2026 is simple: survival. I don't expect the committee to return to the early days of 20+ applications per month; however, once the GMC's share of inflation reaches a more sustainable value, the committee hopes to resume reviewing 10+ applications per month.

At the time of publishing, Saturn 1—Rocket Pool's largest upgrade to date—is expected to launch in roughly two weeks. Toward the end of 2025, the GMC exhausted the remainder of its funds prioritizing marketing efforts for Saturn 1, which will roll out alongside the launch.

With Saturn 1, the committee is hoping for two outcomes: (1) RPL price appreciation, which would directly increase the GMC's spending capacity, and (2) the redirection of a portion of RPL rewards from node operators. Together, these changes are expected to help close the current funding gap.

